ERA 11

Radical Reconstruction

1867 – 1870

The Reconstruction Amendments · Black political power · impeachment

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did Radical Reconstruction try to remake the South—and secure Black citizenship?

KEY TERMS

Military Reconstruction · the 13th, 14th & 15th Amendments · the Freedmen's Bureau · impeachment

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 5.10 · AMSCO Ch. 5.10

RADICAL RECONSTRUCTION

Congress Takes Control

Military Reconstruction, 1867



- The **Radical Republicans** seized control of Reconstruction.
- The **Military Reconstruction Act** split the South into 5 districts under army rule.
- To rejoin the Union, states had to **grant** Black suffrage and ratify the **14th Amendment**.

The Reconstruction Amendments

Three amendments redefined freedom and citizenship

AMENDMENT	YEAR	WHAT IT DID
13th	1865	Abolished slavery everywhere in the U.S.
14th	1868	Granted **citizenship** and '**equal protection**' to all born in the U.S.
15th	1870	Barred denying the vote based on race

The Freedmen's Bureau

- The **Freedmen's Bureau** aided the transition from slavery to freedom.
- It provided food, clothing, and—above all—**schools**.
- It helped found **HBCUs** like Fisk and Howard University.



Black Political Power

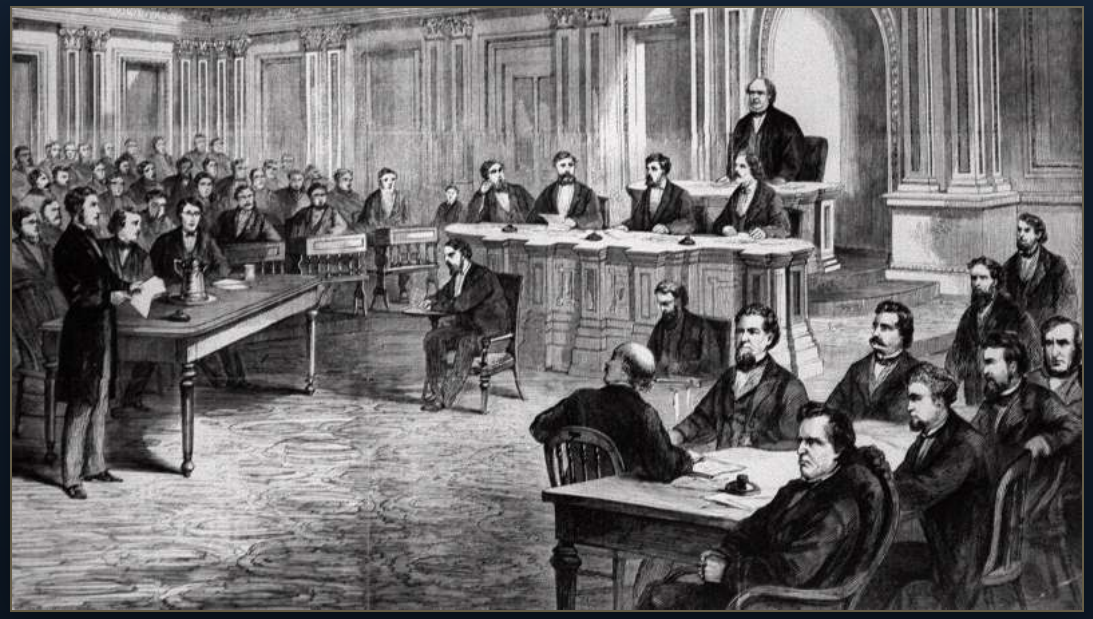


- Over 500,000 Black men voted for the first time.
- **Hiram Revels** of Mississippi became the first Black U.S. Senator.
- Sixteen Black men served in Congress during Reconstruction.

SECTION

A Clash of Branches

The Impeachment of Johnson



- President Johnson fought the Radicals at every turn.
- In 1868 the House **impeached** him.
- The Senate acquitted him by a single vote.

Securing the Vote

AMENDMENT

The 15th Amendment

Ratified in 1870, it protects Black men's right to vote.

→

TURNOUT

Black Voters Mobilize

Hundreds of thousands cast ballots across the South.

→

RESULT

Grant Elected

Ulysses S. Grant wins the presidency in 1868 with Black support.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Radical Reconstruction

1. **Radical Republicans** imposed **Military Reconstruction** and passed the **13th, 14th, and 15th Amendments**.
2. The **Freedmen's Bureau** and Black voters produced a real—if brief—political revolution (**Hiram Revels** and 16 Black congressmen).
3. The struggle peaked with the **impeachment** of Johnson and the election of **Grant**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

Radical Reconstruction

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the **Reconstruction Amendments** transformed the meaning of American citizenship.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How revolutionary was **Black political participation** during Reconstruction? What made it possible?

ARGUMENTATION

Was **Radical Reconstruction** too harsh, or not far-reaching enough? Defend your claim.

Up next — **Class 31: The End of Reconstruction** (sharecropping, the KKK & the Compromise of 1877)